



Board Examinations Policies

A Combined JCQ Compliance Policy Suite

Centre: 74684

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Document Title	External Examinations Policies & Procedures
Centre Number	74684
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Policies Included	Malpractice & Maladministration Policy; Candidate Absence Policy; Candidate Late Arrival Policy; Food & Drink Policy (Exams); Access to Scripts, Review of Results and Appeals Procedure; Internal Appeals Procedure; Certificate Issue Procedure and Retention Policy
Compliance Framework	JCQ (Joint Council for Qualifications) General Regulations for Approved Centres and associated publications
Note on Review Dates	Each policy below retains its own individual review date and next review date, as set out at the start of that section

Section 2

Malpractice & Maladministration Policy

2.1 Introduction: What is Malpractice and Maladministration?

'Malpractice' and 'maladministration' are related concepts, the common theme of which is that they involve a failure to follow the rules of an examination or assessment. This policy uses the word 'malpractice' to cover both, meaning any act, default or practice which is:

- a breach of the Regulations
- a breach of awarding body requirements regarding how a qualification should be delivered

- a failure to follow established procedures in relation to a qualification which gives rise to prejudice to candidates, compromises public confidence in qualifications, compromises the assessment process or the validity of a result or certificate, or damages the authority, reputation or credibility of any awarding body, Centre, or their officers, employees or agents

CANDIDATE MALPRACTICE

Malpractice by a candidate in connection with any examination or assessment, including the preparation and authentication of controlled assessments, coursework or non-examination assessments, the presentation of practical work, the compilation of portfolios of assessment evidence, and the writing of any examination paper.

CENTRE STAFF MALPRACTICE

Malpractice committed by a member of staff, contractor or volunteer at a Centre, or an individual appointed in another capacity such as an invigilator, communication professional, language modifier, practical assistant, prompter, reader or scribe.

SUSPECTED MALPRACTICE

For the purposes of this document, suspected malpractice means all alleged or suspected incidents of malpractice.

2.2 Purpose of the Policy

To confirm that Providence School has in place a written malpractice policy covering all qualifications delivered by the Centre, detailing how candidates are informed and advised to avoid committing malpractice, and how suspected malpractice issues should be escalated within the Centre and reported to the relevant awarding body.

2.3 General Principles

- Take all reasonable steps to prevent the occurrence of any malpractice (including maladministration) before, during and after examinations.
- Inform the awarding body immediately of any alleged, suspected or actual incidents of malpractice or maladministration, involving a candidate or a member of staff, by completing the appropriate documentation.
- As required by an awarding body, gather evidence of any instances of alleged or suspected malpractice in accordance with the JCQ publication Suspected Malpractice — Policies and Procedures, and provide such information and advice as reasonably required.

2.4 Preventing Malpractice

Providence School has robust processes in place to prevent and identify malpractice, as outlined in section 3 of the JCQ publication Suspected Malpractice: Policies and Procedures. This includes ensuring all staff involved in delivering assessments and examinations understand the requirements specified in: General Regulations for Approved Centres; Instructions for Conducting Examinations (ICE); Instructions for Conducting Coursework; Instructions for Conducting Non-Examination Assessments; Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments; A Guide to the Special Consideration Process; Suspected Malpractice: Policies and Procedures; Plagiarism in Assessments; AI Use in Assessments: Protecting the Integrity of Qualifications; and A Guide to the Awarding Bodies' Appeals Processes.

2.5 Informing and Advising Candidates

All candidates are directed to the required candidate information at the start of the school year in which they take examinations. This information is sent again alongside their exam timetables. Prior to the exam season, an assembly is delivered to all candidates outlining malpractice and its possible consequences. Communication and assemblies also explain the importance of students submitting their own intended work and stress the risks of malpractice.

AI USE IN ASSESSMENTS

Providence School recognises the risk to the integrity of the assessment process from the misuse of artificial intelligence, and stays up to date with JCQ guidance (jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice/artificial-intelligence/). This is shared with subject leaders for further dissemination, and all staff involved have been informed in advance regarding the use of AI in examinations and assessments.

2.6 Identification and Reporting of Malpractice

ESCALATING SUSPECTED MALPRACTICE ISSUES

Once suspected malpractice is identified, any member of staff can report it through the appropriate channels. Suspected malpractice should be reported to the next person in the following chain: the lead invigilators in the room (if in an exam), who report to the exams officer, who in turn makes the head of Centre aware. The malpractice is then reported to the relevant exam board.

REPORTING SUSPECTED MALPRACTICE TO THE AWARDING BODY

- The head of Centre notifies the appropriate awarding body immediately of all alleged, suspected or actual incidents, using the appropriate forms, and conducts any investigation in accordance with the JCQ publication Suspected Malpractice: Policies and Procedures.
- Where a candidate who is a child/vulnerable adult is subject to a malpractice investigation, the candidate's parent/appropriate adult is kept informed of the investigation's progress.
- Form JCQ/M1 notifies an awarding body of candidate malpractice; Form JCQ/M2 notifies suspected staff malpractice/maladministration.
- Malpractice discovered in a controlled assessment, coursework or non-examination assessment prior to the candidate signing the declaration of authentication need not be reported to the awarding body (unless confidential assessment material has potentially been breached, which is reported immediately), and is instead dealt with through internal procedures.
- Where there is sufficient evidence to implicate an individual, that individual will be informed of the rights of accused individuals.
- Once information gathering concludes, the head of Centre submits a written report summarising information obtained and actions taken to the relevant awarding body, accompanied by supporting information. Form JCQ/M1 is used for candidate cases; Form JCQ/M3 for Centre staff.
- The awarding body decides, based on the report and supporting documentation, whether there is evidence of malpractice and whether further investigation is required, informing the head of Centre accordingly.

COMMUNICATING MALPRACTICE DECISIONS

Once a decision is made, it is communicated in writing to the head of Centre as soon as possible. The head of Centre communicates the decision to the individuals concerned, passes on details of any sanctions and action, and informs individuals of their right to appeal.

2.7 Appeals Against Malpractice Decisions

Providence School will provide the individual with information on the process and time frame for submitting an appeal, where relevant, and will refer to the process set out in the JCQ publication A Guide to the Awarding Bodies' Appeals Processes (see Section 7: Internal Appeals Procedure, and Section 6: Access to Scripts, Review of Results and Appeals Procedure, of this document).

Section 3

Candidate Absence Policy

3.1 Purpose of the Policy

The purpose of this policy is to confirm the arrangements for candidates who are absent from an examination at Providence School.

An absent candidate may subsequently arrive once the exam is underway, becoming a late or very late arrival, at which point Providence School reserves the right to exercise discretion whether to allow the candidate to enter the examination room and sit the examination (see Section 4: Candidate Late Arrival Policy).

Based on the circumstances for the absence, and subject to the required conditions being met, an application for special consideration may also be made to the relevant awarding body.

3.2 Identifying and Dealing with Candidate Absence

A candidate is considered absent from an examination if not present on completion of the attendance register once candidates are seated and have started the examination.

Once a candidate is identified as absent, the candidate is contacted immediately as to their whereabouts, and arrangements are made, as far as possible, to ensure their immediate arrival.

If a candidate fails to sit an examination:

- A confirmed candidate absence is clearly recorded on the attendance register which is sent to the examiner.
- The candidate absence is noted on the seating plan by crossing through the candidate's details.

3.3 Roles and Responsibilities

It is the responsibility of Saira Umer to deal with candidate absence once identified, and to deal with candidates who are persistently absent from examinations.

THE ROLE OF INVIGILATORS

- Are informed of the process for dealing with absent candidates through training.
- Ensure absent candidates are clearly indicated on the attendance register.

THE ROLE OF CANDIDATES

- Candidates will be re-charged any relevant entry fees for unauthorised absence from examinations.

3.4 Special Consideration

If a candidate is absent from a timetabled written examination for an acceptable reason, they may be eligible for special consideration — an adjustment to the candidate's terminal grade by the awarding body — provided the following conditions are met:

- The examination is in the candidate's terminal exam series.
- The candidate has completed, or will be able to complete, the required percentage of the assessment to meet the minimum requirements for enhanced grading in cases of acceptable absence.
- The application for special consideration can be supported by appropriate evidence signed by a member of the senior leadership team.

It is the responsibility of Haitham Kanaan to deal with special consideration requests and applications.

Section 4

Candidate Late Arrival Policy

4.1 Purpose of the Policy

The purpose of this policy is to confirm the arrangements for candidates who arrive late for an examination at Providence School.

A candidate is considered late if they arrive after the start of the examination and (for an examination lasting an hour or more) up to 10:00am for a morning examination or up to 2:30pm for an afternoon examination.

A candidate is considered very late if they arrive: more than one hour after the awarding body's published starting time for an examination lasting one hour or more (i.e. after 10:00am for a morning exam or after 2:30pm for an afternoon exam); or after the awarding body's published finishing time for an examination lasting less than one hour.

Providence School reserves the right to exercise discretion whether to allow a candidate who arrives after the start of the examination to enter the examination room and sit the examination, and confirms the correct procedures and appropriate arrangements are in place for the management of late arrivals in order to maintain the security and integrity of the examination.

4.2 Candidates Who Arrive Late

- A candidate who arrives after the start of the examination may be allowed to enter the room and sit the examination, and will be allowed the full time for the

examination.

- A candidate arriving within one hour of the published starting time (up to 10:00am/2:30pm) will be permitted by the Centre to sit the examination.
- A candidate arriving after 10:00am (morning) or 2:30pm (afternoon) will be considered very late and will still be permitted by the Centre to sit the examination, as will a candidate arriving after the published finishing time for an exam lasting less than one hour.
- A candidate who arrives very late will be warned that the awarding body may not accept their script.
- A candidate arriving in the afternoon for a paper re-arranged from the morning may be allowed to take it at the published time, provided they have had no contact with candidates who sat it earlier; the awarding body will be informed and will decide whether to accept the script.

In all cases, the Centre submits a declaration for the very late arrival of a candidate, in accordance with the current JCQ Instructions for Conducting Examinations.

Centre-specific procedure: the EO/invigilator conducts an exam briefing for the late candidate outside the exam venue, including normal reminders about unauthorised materials. All invigilators are informed, through training, of the process for dealing with late and very late candidates.

4.3 Roles and Responsibilities

THE EXAMS OFFICER

- Informs invigilators of the policy/process for dealing with late/very late candidates through training.
- Provides an exam room incident log for invigilators to record relevant information.
- Warns a candidate who arrives very late that the awarding body may not accept their script.
- Sends the script of a late/very late candidate to the awarding body/examiner in the normal way.
- Submits online, via the Centre Admin Portal (CAP), the JCQ report on a candidate admitted very late to the examination room within seven days of the exam, providing: the time the candidate came under Centre staff supervision; the reason for the late arrival, including any special arrangements made; the actual starting and finishing times of the examination; the time the candidate started and finished; and assurances that the candidate did not access or become aware of the paper's content beforehand.

THE ROLE OF INVIGILATORS

- Ensure late/very late candidates receive the required instructions prior to starting, without disturbing other candidates.
- Ensure relevant information is recorded on the exam room incident log.
- Allow a candidate who arrived late/very late, and is given the full working time, to continue after the normal finishing time, instructing them to stop once their full time has passed.
- Write the candidate's new start and finish times clearly on their desk.

THE ROLE OF PARENTS AND PUPILS

If a candidate/parent knows they/their child will arrive 'very late' for an exam, they must:

- Contact the school office immediately to inform them of the expected lateness and give an approximate time of arrival.
- Keep the candidate under supervision at all times, with no access to a phone, the internet, etc.
- Personally drive or escort the candidate from home to school by private vehicle or taxi, avoiding public transport.
- Remain with the candidate until collected by the Examinations Manager, and sign a statement confirming supervision arrangements were followed.

The same procedure applies if the candidate has not phoned in and the school makes the initial contact with the parent to advise them of the candidate's non-arrival.

Section 5

Food & Drink Policy (Exams)

5.1 Purpose of the Policy

This policy confirms that Providence School reserves the right to exercise discretion whether to allow food and drink in the examination room, and confirms that the correct procedures are followed and appropriate arrangements are in place for the management of food and drink in the examination room.

5.2 Food and Drink in the Examination Room

- Food and drink is allowed in the examination room at the discretion of the head of Centre.
- Any food and drink brought into the examination room, whether by the candidate or the Centre, must be free from packaging, with all labels removed from drink containers.
- To enable invigilators to check these items quickly and efficiently, drinks bottles must be transparent with no writing, pictures or labels on them.

Centre arrangement: Only water in transparent bottles, with no writing, pictures or labels, is allowed in the examination room. Food is not allowed in the examination room unless prior consent from the exams officer has been sought.

5.3 Roles and Responsibilities

THE EXAMS OFFICE / OFFICER

- Through briefings, ensures candidates are aware of the regulations and Centre-specific arrangements relating to food and drink in the examination room.
- Ensures invigilators are trained and aware of the regulations/Centre-specific arrangements.
- Escalates any issue or breach of Centre-specific arrangements to the relevant senior leader for internal sanction(s).
- Escalates any breach of JCQ regulations immediately to the head of Centre (a breach

constitutes suspected or actual malpractice).

THE ROLE OF THE INVIGILATOR

- Is vigilant in the examination room, remaining aware of incidents or emerging situations and looking out for malpractice.
- Records what has happened and actions taken on the exam room incident log in relation to any breach of regulations/Centre-specific arrangements regarding food and drink.

THE ROLE OF THE HEAD OF CENTRE

- Reports to the awarding body immediately all cases of suspected or actual malpractice in connection with the examination.

Section 6

Access to Scripts, Review of Results and Appeals Procedure

These procedures are reviewed and updated annually to ensure that Providence English Private School deals with candidates' requests for access to scripts, clerical re-checks, reviews of marking, reviews of moderation and appeals to the awarding bodies in accordance with current requirements and regulations. References to GR and PRS refer to the JCQ publications General Regulations for Approved Centres and Post-Results Services.

6.1 Introduction: Post-Results Services

Following the issue of results, awarding bodies make post-results services available:

ACCESS TO SCRIPTS (ATS)

- Copies of scripts to support reviews of marking.
- Copies of scripts to support teaching and learning.

REVIEWS OF RESULTS (RORS)

- Service 1 (Clerical re-check) — the only service that can be requested for objective tests (multiple choice tests).
- Service 2 (Review of marking).
- Priority Service 2 (Review of marking) — available for externally assessed components of GCE A-level specifications (an individual awarding body may also offer this for other qualifications).
- Service 3 (Review of moderation) — not available to an individual candidate.

APPEALS

The appeals process is available after receiving the outcome of a review of results.

6.2 Purpose of the Procedures

To confirm how Providence English School deals with candidates' requests for access to scripts, clerical re-checks, reviews of marking, reviews of moderation and appeals, in compliance with JCQ regulations. Pupils are issued a Candidate Exam Handbook in the

spring term containing essential exam information, including how to request these services.

6.3 Arrangements for Post-Results Services

- Candidates are made aware of post-results service arrangements prior to the issue of results.
- A review of moderation cannot be undertaken on the work of an individual candidate or candidates not in the original sample.
- The appeals process is available after receiving the outcome of a review of results.
- Candidates are informed of the periods during which senior Centre staff will be available immediately after results publication, so results may be discussed and decisions made on submitting reviews of marking.

6.4 Dealing with Requests

- Written candidate consent is acquired (informed consent via candidate email is accepted) in all cases before a request for a clerical re-check, review of marking, or access to scripts is submitted.
- Informed candidate consent confirms the candidate understands the final subject grade/mark following a clerical re-check, review of marking, or subsequent appeal may be lower than, higher than, or the same as the original result.
- Candidate consent is only collected after the publication of results.
- Consent forms/emails are retained for at least six months following the outcome of a clerical re-check, review of marking, or subsequent appeal, and permission to request/use scripts is retained for at least six months.

6.5 Submitting Requests

- Requests for clerical re-checks, reviews of marking, reviews of moderation and access to scripts are submitted electronically by the published deadline(s), per the JCQ publication Post-Results Services.
- Requests for appeals are submitted in accordance with A Guide to the Awarding Bodies' Appeals Processes.
- The awarding body's acknowledgement of receipt is confirmed prior to the submission deadline, and progress is checked regularly online.

6.6 Dealing with Outcomes

- Outcomes of clerical re-checks, reviews of marking, reviews of moderation and appeals are made known to candidates as soon as possible.
- Candidates are emailed a copy of the outcome notification from the awarding body.

6.7 Managing Disputes

Any dispute or disagreement is managed in accordance with the Internal Appeals Procedure (Section 7 of this document), used when a candidate disagrees with a Centre decision not to support an application for a clerical re-check, a review of marking, a review of moderation, or an appeal.

Internal Appeals Procedure

7.1 Purpose of the Procedure

This procedure confirms Providence English Private School's compliance with JCQ's General Regulations for Approved Centres (sections 5.3z, 5.8) — that the Centre will have in place and available for inspection a written internal appeals procedure covering at least appeals regarding internal assessment decisions, post-results services and appeals, and Centre decisions relating to access arrangements and special consideration, and will draw this procedure to the attention of candidates and their parents.

This procedure covers appeals relating to:

- Internal assessment decisions (Centre assessed marks)
- Centre decisions not to support an application for a clerical re-check, a review of marking, a review of moderation or an appeal
- Centre decisions relating to access arrangements and special consideration
- Centre decisions relating to other administrative issues

7.2 Appeals Relating to Internal Assessment Decisions

Certain GCSE, GCE and other qualifications contain non-examination assessment or coursework components which are internally assessed (marked) by the Centre and internally standardised. Marks contributing to the final grade are submitted by the awarding body's deadline for external moderation.

The Centre will have in place, and available for inspection, a written internal appeals procedure relating to internal assessment decisions, communicated and made accessible to all candidates, and will inform candidates of their Centre assessed marks before submission so they may request a review of the Centre's marking.

DEADLINES FOR THE SUBMISSION OF MARKS

Providence English Private School is committed to ensuring that marking is done fairly, consistently and in accordance with the awarding body's specification and subject-specific guidance. The Centre follows a robust Non-Examination Assessment Policy for the management of GCE and GCSE non-examination assessments, including marking and quality assurance/internal standardisation processes.

Candidates' work is marked by appropriately trained staff, and authenticated in line with awarding body requirements. Where more than one teacher marks a candidate's work, internal moderation and standardisation ensure consistency.

On being informed of their Centre assessed marks, if a candidate believes the above procedures were not followed, or that marking standards were not properly applied, they may use the appeals procedure below to consider requesting a review of the Centre's marking.

Providence English Private School will:

- Ensure candidates are informed of their Centre assessed marks so they may request a

review before marks are submitted to the awarding body.

- Inform candidates they must explain the grounds for a review, as a review only focuses on the quality of the work submitted.
- Inform candidates they may request copies of materials (generally the marked assessment material and mark scheme/assessment criteria, plus subject-specific extras) to help decide whether to request a review.
- Make requested copies available promptly (within 7 calendar days), or, for materials such as artwork or recordings, share the originals under supervised conditions.
- Inform candidates they will not be allowed unsupervised access to original assessment material.
- Give candidates sufficient time to review copies and decide, explaining what they believe the issue to be if they proceed.
- Set a clear deadline for a review request — in writing, within 7 calendar days of receiving the requested materials, via the internal appeals form. Requests after this deadline are not accepted.
- Allow 14 calendar days to carry out the review, make necessary mark changes, and inform the candidate of the outcome — all before the awarding body's deadline for submission of marks.
- Ensure the review is conducted by an assessor with appropriate competence, no previous involvement in that candidate's assessment for the component, and no personal interest in the outcome, and instruct the reviewer to ensure consistency with the Centre's set standard.
- Inform the candidate in writing of the review outcome.

The outcome is made known to the head of Centre, who has the final decision on any disagreement over the mark to be submitted. A written record is kept and made available to the awarding body on request. The awarding body is informed if the Centre does not accept a review outcome.

Moderation by the awarding body may result in a mark change, upwards or downwards, even after an internal review — the internal review ensures consistency within the Centre, while awarding-body moderation ensures Centre marking aligns with national standards. The mark submitted is therefore provisional.

7.3 Appeals Relating to Post-Results Service Decisions

This procedure confirms compliance with JCQ's GR section 5.13 — that the Centre will have available for inspection, and draw to candidates' and parents' attention, a written procedure to manage disputes when a candidate disagrees with a Centre decision not to support an application for a clerical re-check, a review of marking, a review of moderation, or an appeal.

Following the issue of results, awarding bodies make post-results services available; full details, internal deadlines and fees are provided by the exams officer. Candidates are informed of these arrangements prior to the issue of results, and of the periods when senior Centre staff will be available afterwards, via the school portal or email.

Where the Centre or a candidate (or parent) has a concern that a result may not be accurate, post-results services may be considered. Available JCQ services are: Reviews of Results (Service 1 clerical re-check; Service 2 review of marking; Priority Service 2; Service 3 review of moderation, not available to an individual candidate) and Access to

Scripts (copies to support a review of marking, or to support teaching and learning).

For written components, the Centre will: consider a Priority Service 2 review where a university/college place is at risk; otherwise access the script (via a priority copy or online viewing where available); collect informed written consent to access the script; assess whether the mark scheme was correctly applied; support a clerical re-check or review of marking if an error is identified; collect informed written consent before submitting the request; and, where relevant, advise the candidate to inform any affected third party (e.g. a university) that a review has been submitted.

Written candidate consent (informed consent via email is acceptable) is required in all cases before a request for RoR service 1 or 2 (including priority service 2) is submitted, confirming the candidate understands the result may be lower, higher, or the same. Consent is only collected after results are published.

For moderated components, the Centre will confirm a review of moderation cannot be undertaken on an individual candidate's work or on candidates outside the original sample, consult the moderator's report, determine if internally assessed marks were accepted without change (in which case Service 3 is not available), and determine any grounds for a review of moderation for the full original sample.

Where a candidate disagrees with a Centre decision not to support a clerical re-check, review of marking or review of moderation, the Centre will advise them of the relevant consent, fee and deadline requirements for each service, and inform them that a review of moderation cannot be requested for an individual candidate.

If the candidate (or parent) believes there are grounds to appeal the Centre's decision, an internal appeal can be submitted by completing the internal appeals form at least 7 calendar days prior to the internal deadline for submitting a request for a review of results. The appellant is informed of the outcome before that internal deadline.

Following the RoR outcome, an external appeals process is available if the head of Centre remains dissatisfied and believes there are grounds for appeal, consulting the JCQ Post-Results Services and Appeals Booklet publications to determine acceptable grounds for a preliminary appeal. Candidates or parents are not permitted to make direct representations to an awarding body.

The internal appeals form must be submitted within 7 calendar days of the RoR outcome notification, allowing the Centre to process a preliminary appeal within the required 30 calendar days of the awarding body's outcome. Any awarding body fees for the preliminary appeal must be paid by the appellant to the Centre before submission; if the appeal is upheld, this fee is refunded by the awarding body and repaid to the appellant by the Centre.

7.4 Appeals Relating to Access Arrangements and Special Consideration

This procedure confirms compliance with JCQ's GR section 5.3z. Providence English Private School will comply with the principles and regulations governing access arrangements and special consideration as set out in Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments and A Guide to the Special Consideration Process, and ensure all staff managing these processes are aware of requirements and appropriately supported and resourced.

ACCESS ARRANGEMENTS AND REASONABLE ADJUSTMENTS

The Centre recognises its duty to explore and provide access to suitable courses through the access arrangements process, submits applications for reasonable adjustments, and complies with its responsibilities in identifying, determining and implementing appropriate arrangements. Failure to comply may constitute malpractice, which may impact a candidate's results. Examples of failure to comply include: putting in place unapproved arrangements/adjustments; failing to consider putting in place access arrangements; permitting arrangements not supported by appropriate evidence; and charging a fee for reasonable adjustments to disabled candidates.

SPECIAL CONSIDERATION

Where the Centre has appropriate evidence signed by a senior leadership team member, it will apply for special consideration at the time of assessment for a candidate who has temporarily experienced illness, injury or another event outside their control which has had, or is reasonably likely to have had, a material effect on their ability to take an assessment or demonstrate their normal level of attainment.

CENTRE DECISIONS AND THE APPEALS ROUTE

This may include a Centre decision not to make/apply for a specific reasonable adjustment, or not to apply for special consideration, where a candidate does not meet the criteria or there is insufficient evidence.

- If the candidate (or parent) disagrees with the decision and reasonably believes the Centre has not complied with its responsibilities or followed due procedure, a written request setting out the grounds for appeal should be submitted.
- An internal appeals form should be completed and submitted within 5 working days of the decision being made known to the appellant.

To determine the outcome, the head of Centre consults the respective JCQ publication to confirm the Centre complied with the relevant principles, regulations and procedures. The appellant is informed of the outcome within 30 calendar/working days of the appeal being received and logged. If the appeal is upheld, the Centre proceeds to implement the necessary arrangements or submit the necessary application.

7.5 Appeals Relating to Other Administrative Issues

Circumstances may arise causing the Centre to make decisions on administrative issues affecting a candidate's examinations/assessments.

- If the affected candidate (or parent) disagrees with the decision and reasonably believes the Centre has not complied with regulations or followed due process, a written request setting out the grounds for appeal should be submitted.
- An internal appeals form should be completed and submitted within 5 calendar/working days of the decision being made known to the appellant.

The appellant is informed of the outcome within 30 calendar/working days of the appeal being received and logged by the Centre.

7.6 Internal Appeals Form

Please tick the box to indicate the nature of your appeal and complete all boxes on the form below.

- ☐ Appeal against an internal assessment decision and/or request for a review of

marking

- ☐ Appeal against the Centre's decision not to support a clerical re-check, a review of marking, a review of moderation or an appeal
- ☐ Appeal against the Centre's decision relating to access arrangements or special consideration
- ☐ Appeal against the Centre's decision relating to an administrative issue

Note: Where the nature of the appeal does not relate directly to an awarding body's specific qualification, indicate N/A in the awarding-body-specific detail boxes.

Name of Appellant	
Candidate Name (if different)	
Awarding Body	
Exam Paper Code	
Qualification Type	
Subject	
Exam Paper Title	

Please state the grounds for your appeal below:

☐ Where my appeal is against an internal assessment decision, I wish to request a review of the Centre's marking.

(Continue on an additional page if completing electronically, or overleaf if completing a hard copy.)

Appellant Signature	Date of Signature
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This form must be signed, dated and returned to the exams officer on behalf of the head of Centre within the timescale indicated in the relevant appeals procedure.

FOR CENTRE USE ONLY — APPEALS LOG

Ref No.	Date Received	Appellant Name	Outcome	Outcome Date

On receipt, all appeals are assigned a reference number and logged. The outcome of any review of the Centre's marking is made known to the head of Centre and logged as an appeal so information can be easily made available to an awarding body on request. The

awarding body is informed if the Centre does not accept the outcome of a review — this is noted on this log.

7.7 Further Guidance

- General Regulations for Approved Centres — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/general-regulations
- Post-Results Services — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/post-results-services
- JCQ Appeals Booklet (A Guide to the Awarding Bodies' Appeals Processes) — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/appeals
- Notice to Centres — Informing Candidates of Their Centre Assessed Marks — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/non-examination-assessments
- Suspected Malpractice: Policies and Procedures — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice/
- Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/access-arrangements-and-special-consideration/regulations-and-guidance/
- A Guide to the Special Consideration Process — jcq.org.uk/exams-office/access-arrangements-and-special-consideration/regulations-and-guidance/
- AI Use in Assessments: Protecting the Integrity of Qualifications — JCQ Joint Council for Qualifications

Section 8

Certificate Issue Procedure and Retention Policy

8.1 Introduction

Certificates are provided by awarding bodies after examination results have been confirmed. Certificates always remain the property of the awarding bodies.

8.2 Purpose of the Policy

To confirm how Providence English School issues examination certificates to candidates, and the policy for retaining any unclaimed/uncollected certificates, in compliance with JCQ regulations.

8.3 Issue of Certificates

- Obtain and maintain accurate candidate contact information to ensure correct and secure dispatch of certificates.
- Distribute certificates to all candidates without delay and regardless of any disputes.
- Not withhold any certificate without prior permission from the relevant awarding body, given only in very exceptional circumstances.
- Keep a record of certificates issued.
- Return any certificates requested by the awarding bodies, as certificates always remain the awarding bodies' property.

The receipt of certificates from awarding bodies, and arrangements for issuing

certificates to candidates, is managed by the Examinations Officer in discussion with the Headteacher.

8.4 Arrangements for the Issue of Certificates

- Certificates are presented in person to the candidate at a pre-arranged time, or posted to the candidate's home address using recorded delivery.
- Candidates are informed of the arrangements for issuing certificates in writing and via email.
- Where a student cannot collect certificates in person and does not wish them posted, a third party may collect on the candidate's behalf, providing written authorisation from the candidate and a form of ID.

8.5 Record of Issued Certificates

Collected certificates must be signed for to confirm receipt, with the record retained by the Exams Officer. The record of certificates issued is kept for 4 years.

8.6 Retention of Certificates

- Retain all unclaimed certificates under secure conditions for a minimum of 12 months from the date of issue.
- Destroy any unclaimed certificates after retaining them for a minimum of 12 months, in a confidential manner, or return them to the respective awarding body.
- Retain a record of destroyed certificates for four years from their date of destruction.
- Where applicable, inform candidates that some awarding bodies do not offer a replacement certificate service; in such cases, the awarding body issues a Certifying Statement of Results, providing an accurate and complete record of results for all qualifications covered by the original certificate.

The retention of unclaimed or uncollected certificates is managed by the Exams Officer.

8.7 Retention Policy Summary

- All unclaimed certificates are held in the Centre's secure storage facility for 12 months from the date of issue.
- After 12 months, all unclaimed certificates are destroyed in a confidential manner.
- A record is kept by the Exams Officer of all unclaimed certificates that have been destroyed, retained for 4 years from the date of destruction.